"I can't learn or grow anymore."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After injury or with age, we may stop trying new things because of earlier failures. The brain, however, retains the ability to adapt, and spiritual growth does not depend on speed or memory.

What Scripture teaches

"Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day." "He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus." "Be transformed by the renewing of your mind." Spiritual growth in love, patience, and trust does not depend on IQ or memory. And the brain can often form new pathways with practice and rehabilitation. Growth may be slower, but it is real.

> *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day"* (2 Corinthians 4:16).

Also see

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

> "The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks it out" (Proverbs 18:15).

Common self-statements

- My learning days are over.
- I am stuck where I am.
- New things are too hard.
- I will never improve.
- Therapy is pointless.
- I can only go backward.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing growth is either fast or impossible.
- Fortune telling: Predicting no improvement.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling stuck and concluding I cannot grow.
- Labeling: Calling myself stuck.

Challenging questions

- What have I learned or recovered since the injury?
- What small goal could I try?
- What therapists or programs could help?

- How have I grown spiritually through this?
- What does Scripture promise about God's work in me?
- Who can encourage me?

Truth summary

> Growth continues, though at a different pace. My inner self is renewed daily, and God will complete His work in me. I can learn in small steps.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Thinking, Healthy
- Faith
- Trust
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I can't learn or grow anymore"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I can't learn or grow anymore." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I learned or recovered since the injury?
- ☐ What small goal could I try?
- ☐ What therapists or programs could help?
- ☐ How have I grown spiritually through this?
- ☐ What does Scripture promise about God's work in me?
- ☐ Who can encourage me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My inner self is renewed daily.
- ☐ God will complete His work.
- ☐ My mind can be renewed.
- ☐ Small steps count.
- ☐ I can grow spiritually.
- ☐ I am not stuck.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 2 Corinthians 4:16
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day."
- ☐ Philippians 1:6
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Small growth: Each week, note one thing you learned or improved.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 4:16 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God will carry on His good work in me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Set a small goal. Choose one skill to practice.
- [ ] Ask about rehabilitation. Speak with your doctor.
- [ ] Celebrate progress. Write what improved.
- [ ] Read Philippians 1:6. Remember God is working.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I can't learn or grow anymore": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Small growth
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I can't learn or grow anymore.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel stuck. Renew my mind, give me patience for small steps, and finish the work You began in me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.